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Digital and Social Media Marketing

BOE096

One-day revision notes: definitions, solved examples, code and important questions

Program: B.Tech | **Branches:** ALL | **Semester:** 8 | **Credits:** 3 | **L-T-P:** 3-0-0

Scheme: AKTU B.Tech 4th year, Open Elective-IV, 2025-26 onwards

UNIT 1	UNIT 2	UNIT 3	UNIT 4	UNIT 5
Introduction to Digital Marketing and the Digital Consumer	Blogging, Content Planning and Social Media Platforms	Content, Branding, SEM, SEO, Mobile and Video Marketing	Digital Transformation, Online PR and Measuring ROI	Transformation Framework, Security, Privacy and Trends

Original revision notes written for the AKTU syllabus. Every unit has the same parts:

1. **2-mark definitions**: short answers you can write word for word in Section A.
2. **Core concepts**: frameworks, comparison tables and Indian examples.
3. **Examples and calculations**: the metrics examiners ask about (CTR, CPC, CPM, conversion rate, CPA, ROAS, ROI, engagement rate, email rates, bounce rate, customer lifetime value).
4. **Key points to remember**.
5. **Important questions**: the long questions to prepare, with what your answer must contain.

How to use these notes the day before the paper

- **Morning (3 hours):** Unit 1 (traditional vs digital, digital consumer journey, strategy frameworks) and Unit 2 (blogging, content calendar, major social platforms and their ad tools).
- **Afternoon (3 hours):** Unit 3 (content marketing, branding, SEM, SEO, mobile, video, gamification, campaign analytics). Learn the metrics formulas and practise them once.
- **Evening (2 hours):** Unit 4 (digital transformation, digital leadership, online PR, ROI) and Unit 5 (transformation framework, security and privacy, DPDP Act, trends, online communities), then the "Last-hour checklist".
- **In the exam:** draw the funnel (awareness to advocacy), the paid-owned-earned media diagram and a simple SEO on-page versus off-page table. Use Indian examples (Zomato, Amul, Nykaa, Swiggy) to make answers stand out.

AKTU paper pattern (theory, 70 marks, 3 hours): Section A has 7 short questions of 2 marks, all compulsory (14). Section B has 5 questions of 7 marks, attempt any 3 (21). Section C has 5 questions (one per unit), each with two parts, attempt one part of each, 7 marks each (35). Every unit gets its own Section C question, so do not skip any unit.

UNIT 1 Introduction to Digital Marketing and the Digital Consumer

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Digital marketing:** promoting products, services and brands through digital channels such as search engines, websites, social media, email, mobile apps and online ads.
- **Traditional marketing:** promotion through offline media such as print, TV, radio, outdoor hoardings and direct mail.
- **Inbound marketing:** attracting customers with useful content they look for (blogs, SEO, videos), instead of interrupting them.
- **Outbound marketing:** pushing messages to people who did not ask for them (TV ads, cold calls, banner ads).
- **Digital consumer:** a consumer who searches, compares, buys and shares opinions using digital devices and platforms.
- **Customer journey:** the stages a customer goes through from first awareness of a need to purchase and beyond (loyalty, advocacy).
- **Touchpoint:** any point where a customer interacts with a brand (ad, website, review, store, support chat).
- **Omnichannel marketing:** giving the customer a consistent, connected experience across all online and offline channels.
- **Zero Moment of Truth (ZMOT):** the moment a consumer researches a product online before buying (term from Google, 2011).
- **Paid, owned and earned media (POEM):** paid = bought ads; owned = brand's own channels (website, app, social pages); earned = free publicity from shares, reviews and press.

💡 Core concepts

Trends in digital marketing: mobile-first and short video (Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts), influencer and creator marketing, AI-driven personalization and generative AI content, voice and visual search, social commerce (buy inside the app), quick commerce, conversational marketing (WhatsApp Business, chatbots), privacy-first marketing (end of third-party cookies, consent), vernacular content for Bharat users, and UPI-enabled one-tap buying.

Traditional vs digital marketing

Basis	Traditional	Digital
Reach	Local or national, mass	Global, highly targeted
Communication	One-way	Two-way, interactive
Cost	High (TV, print)	Low entry cost, pay per click or impression
Targeting	Broad demographics	Precise: interests, location, behaviour
Measurement	Hard, delayed (surveys, TRP)	Real time, exact (clicks, conversions)

Basis	Traditional	Digital
Changes	Hard to edit after release	Can be edited or paused instantly
Examples	Newspaper ad, TV commercial, hoarding	Google Ads, Instagram post, email newsletter

Moving from traditional to digital: businesses start with a website and social pages, add search and social ads, then build data and CRM systems, automate campaigns, and finally integrate online and offline into one omnichannel experience. Both still work together (a TV ad with a QR code to a landing page).

The digital consumer journey (funnel):

1. **Awareness:** sees a reel, ad or search result.
2. **Consideration:** compares products, reads reviews, watches unboxing videos.
3. **Conversion (purchase):** buys online or offline.
4. **Retention (loyalty):** repeat purchase through email, app notifications and loyalty points.
5. **Advocacy:** posts reviews, refers friends, shares content. - McKinsey's version is a **loop** rather than a funnel: initial consideration → active evaluation → moment of purchase → post-purchase experience → loyalty loop. - Older models: AIDA (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action). - Digital adaptation: **5A (Kotler)**, which is Aware, Appeal, Ask, Act, Advocate.

Digital marketing strategy (steps): situation analysis (SWOT, competitor audit) → set **SMART objectives** (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) → define target audience and buyer personas → choose channels (POEM) → plan content and budget → execute campaigns → measure with KPIs → optimize.

Strategy frameworks:

- **RACE (Smart Insights):** Reach, Act, Convert, Engage.
- **SOSTAC (P. R. Smith):** Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Action, Control.
- **4Ps to 4Cs:** Product → Customer solution, Price → Cost, Place → Convenience, Promotion → Communication.

Channels of digital marketing: SEO, SEM (pay per click), social media marketing, content marketing, email marketing, affiliate marketing, influencer marketing, display advertising, mobile and app marketing, video marketing, online PR.

Examples and calculations

Example 1 (SMART objective). Weak goal: "Increase sales online." SMART goal: "Increase online orders from our Lucknow bakery website by 20% (from 500 to 600 per month) by 31 March, using Instagram ads and Google local search."

Example 2 (buyer persona). "Riya, 21, engineering student in Noida, uses Instagram and YouTube for 3 hours a day, budget-conscious, buys skincare after watching creator reviews, pays by UPI." A skincare brand (such as Minimalist or Mamaearth) targets her with creator reels and student discount codes.

Key points to remember

- Digital vs traditional: two-way, targeted, measurable, cheaper entry, real-time edits.

- Journey: awareness → consideration → conversion → retention → advocacy. Know AIDA, 5A and ZMOT.
- POEM: paid, owned, earned.
- Strategy frameworks: RACE, SOSTAC, SMART objectives.
- Trends: short video, AI personalization, social commerce, vernacular, privacy-first.

⭐ Important questions

1. Differentiate traditional and digital marketing. Explain the shift from traditional to digital with examples.
2. Explain the digital consumer journey. How does a marketer influence each stage? (Funnel diagram, touchpoints, ZMOT.)
3. Discuss the latest trends in digital marketing in India.
4. Explain the steps in building a digital marketing strategy. Describe the SOSTAC or RACE framework.
5. Explain paid, owned and earned media with examples.

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UNIT 2 Blogging, Content Planning and Social Media Platforms

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Blog:** a regularly updated website or section of a website with articles (posts) written in an informal or conversational style.
- **Content calendar:** a schedule that plans what content will be published, on which channel, on which date, and by whom.
- **Content pillar:** a broad theme the brand repeatedly creates content about (for a fitness brand: workouts, nutrition, success stories).
- **Social media marketing (SMM):** using social platforms to build brand awareness, engage audiences and drive traffic and sales.
- **Organic reach:** the number of people who see content without paid promotion.
- **Paid reach:** the number of people who see content because it was promoted with money.
- **Custom audience:** an ad audience built from a brand's own data (customer list, website visitors).
- **Lookalike audience:** an ad audience of new people who resemble an existing custom audience.
- **Hashtag:** a word or phrase preceded by # that groups content on a topic and makes it discoverable.
- **Influencer:** a person with a loyal following who can affect the buying decisions of that audience (nano under 10k followers, micro 10k–100k, macro 100k–1M, mega above 1M).

💡 Core concepts

Blogging:

- **Benefits for business:** SEO traffic, thought leadership, lead generation (with calls to action), and material for social and email.
- **Types of blogs:** personal, corporate or business, niche (food, tech), affiliate, guest blogging.
- **Writing a good post:** know the audience; do keyword research; write a strong headline; structure with subheadings, short paragraphs and lists; add images and alt text; give a clear call to action; link internally and externally; keep a regular posting schedule.
- **Platforms:** WordPress, Blogger, Medium, Substack.

Content planning process: set goals → understand the audience (personas) → audit existing content → choose content pillars and formats (blog, reel, carousel, infographic, podcast, webinar, e-book) → create a content calendar → produce, publish and distribute → promote → measure and refine. Useful rules: **80/20 rule** (80% helpful or entertaining content, 20% promotional) and repurposing (one webinar becomes a blog, reels and a carousel).

Major social media platforms

Platform	Strength and audience	Best content	Ad tools
Facebook	Largest user base, wide age range	Community posts, groups, events, videos	Meta Ads Manager, custom and lookalike audiences, lead ads
Instagram	Youth, visual, lifestyle, D2C brands	Reels, stories, carousels, shopping	Meta Ads (Reels ads, Story ads), collabs with creators
YouTube	Long and short video, search engine for video, strong in India	Tutorials, reviews, vlogs, Shorts	Google Ads video campaigns (skippable in-stream, bumper 6 s)
X (Twitter)	Real-time news, conversations, customer service	Short posts, threads, trends	Promoted posts, trend takeover
LinkedIn	Professionals, B2B, recruitment	Thought leadership articles, company updates	Sponsored content, InMail, targeting by job title and industry
WhatsApp	Highest reach in India, personal messaging	Broadcasts, catalogues, chat support	WhatsApp Business API, click-to-WhatsApp ads
Pinterest, Snapchat, ShareChat, Moj	Niche audiences, regional language (ShareChat)	Ideas, AR filters, vernacular short video	Platform ad managers

Social media advertising structure (Meta example): Campaign (objective: awareness, traffic, engagement, leads, app promotion, sales) → Ad set (audience, placements, budget, schedule) → Ad (creative, copy, call to action). Bidding is through an auction based on bid, estimated action rate and ad quality.

Social media strategy: goals and KPIs, audience, platform choice, content mix, posting frequency, community management (replying to comments and messages), social listening (tracking mentions and sentiment), influencer collaborations, paid boosting, and analytics.

Examples: Amul's topical cartoons (long-running moment marketing), Zomato's witty X posts and push notifications, Swiggy's "Instamart" reels, Cadbury's "Not Just a Cadbury Ad" (2021) which used AI to personalize ads for local stores.

Examples and calculations

Example 3 (engagement rate). An Instagram post on a page with 40,000 followers gets 900 likes, 150 comments and 150 shares.

- Engagement = 900 + 150 + 150 = 1,200.
- Engagement rate = 1,200 / 40,000 × 100 = **3%** (above 1 to 3% is generally good for a page of this size).

Example 4 (content calendar row). Week 1, Monday: Instagram reel, pillar "recipes", topic "5-minute millet breakfast", owner Priya, CTA "save and share", goal reach. Wednesday: blog post with the same recipe and SEO keyword "millet breakfast recipe", goal traffic. Friday: email to subscribers linking the blog, goal clicks.

Key points to remember

- Blog benefits: SEO, leads, authority; good post structure and CTA.
- Content planning: goals → personas → pillars → calendar → produce → promote → measure. 80/20 rule, repurposing.
- Platform table: Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, X, LinkedIn, WhatsApp.
- Meta ads: campaign → ad set → ad; custom and lookalike audiences.
- Engagement rate = engagements / followers (or reach) × 100.

⭐ Important questions

1. What is blogging? Explain its importance for business and the steps to write an effective blog post.
2. Explain the content planning process. How is a content calendar prepared? Give a sample.
3. Compare the major social media platforms for marketing and their advertising options.
4. How do you plan and run a paid social media campaign? (Objective, audience, budget, creative, measurement.)
5. Write a note on influencer marketing with its types and Indian examples.

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UNIT 3 Content, Branding, SEM, SEO, Mobile and Video Marketing

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Content marketing:** creating and distributing valuable, relevant content to attract and keep a clearly defined audience and drive profitable action.
- **Digital branding:** building a brand's identity, voice and reputation through online channels.
- **SEO (search engine optimization):** improving a website so that it ranks higher in unpaid (organic) search results.
- **SEM (search engine marketing):** promoting a website in search results, mainly through paid search ads (pay per click). In a broad sense it includes SEO.
- **PPC (pay per click):** an ad model where the advertiser pays only when someone clicks the ad.
- **Quality Score:** Google's 1–10 rating of a keyword's expected CTR, ad relevance and landing page experience; a higher score lowers the cost per click.
- **Keyword:** a word or phrase people type into a search engine; long-tail keywords are longer, more specific phrases with lower competition.
- **Backlink:** a link from another website to yours; quality backlinks improve SEO authority.
- **Mobile marketing:** reaching customers on smartphones through SMS, apps, push notifications, mobile web and in-app ads.
- **Gamification:** using game elements (points, badges, levels, leaderboards, rewards) in marketing to increase engagement.

💡 Core concepts

Content and branding:

- **Content types:** blogs, videos, infographics, case studies, e-books, podcasts, user-generated content, memes.
- **Storytelling** creates emotional connection.
- **Digital brand elements:** logo and visual identity, tone of voice, consistent handles, website, brand values, reputation management.
- **Brand building online:** consistent content, community, influencers, purpose-led campaigns, customer reviews.

SEO

Type	What it covers	Examples
On-page SEO	Content and HTML of each page	Keyword in title tag, meta description, headings (H1, H2), URL, image alt text, internal links, quality content
Off-page SEO	Signals from outside the site	Backlinks, guest posts, social signals, brand mentions, local citations
Technical SEO	Site infrastructure	Fast page speed, mobile-friendliness, HTTPS, XML sitemap, robots.txt, structured data (schema), Core Web Vitals

Type	What it covers	Examples
Local SEO	Visibility in local and map searches	Google Business Profile, reviews, NAP (name, address, phone) consistency

- **How search engines work:** crawl (bots follow links) → index (store and understand pages) → rank (algorithm orders results by relevance and quality, using E-E-A-T, which is experience, expertise, authoritativeness and trust).
- **White-hat vs black-hat:** white-hat follows search engine guidelines. Black-hat (keyword stuffing, cloaking, link farms) risks penalties.

SEM / Google Ads:

- **Campaign types:** Search, Display, Video, Shopping, App, Performance Max.
- **Keyword match types:** broad, phrase, exact; plus negative keywords.
- **Ad Rank** depends on bid × quality (Quality Score, expected impact of extensions); the advertiser pays just enough to beat the next ad rank.
- **Bidding:** manual CPC, maximize clicks, target CPA, target ROAS.

SEO vs SEM

SEO	SEM (paid search)
Organic, no payment per click	Pay per click
Slow, takes months	Immediate results
Long-lasting	Stops when budget stops
Higher trust from users	Marked "Sponsored"

Mobile marketing: SMS and RCS messages, WhatsApp Business messages, push notifications, in-app ads, app store optimization (ASO), QR codes, location-based marketing (geofencing), mobile wallets and UPI offers, responsive or mobile-first websites.

Video marketing:

- **Formats:** explainers, product demos, testimonials, live streams, short-form reels, webinars.
- **Tips:** hook in the first 3 seconds, subtitles (most mobile video is watched muted), vertical format for Shorts and Reels, a clear CTA, thumbnails.
- **Metrics:** views, view-through rate, average watch time, engagement.

Gamification examples: Swiggy and Zomato scratch cards, Google Pay rewards, Duolingo streaks, Starbucks Rewards stars, brand quizzes and contests on Instagram.

Campaign analytics:

- **Tools:** Google Analytics 4 (events-based), Google Search Console, Meta Business Suite insights, UTM parameters to track sources.
- **Attribution models:** last-click, first-click, linear, time-decay, data-driven.
- **Key metrics:**
- CTR = clicks / impressions.
- CPC = cost / clicks.
- CPM = cost per 1,000 impressions.

- Conversion rate = conversions / clicks.
- CPA = cost / conversions.
- ROAS = revenue / ad spend.
- Bounce rate (older Universal Analytics term) and engagement rate (GA4).

Examples and calculations

Example 5 (ad campaign metrics). A Google Ads campaign gets 2,00,000 impressions and 3,000 clicks at a total cost of ₹15,000. It produces 90 orders worth ₹72,000.

- CTR = 3,000 / 2,00,000 = **1.5%**.
- CPC = 15,000 / 3,000 = **₹5**.
- CPM = 15,000 / 200 = **₹75**.
- Conversion rate = 90 / 3,000 = **3%**.
- CPA = 15,000 / 90 = **₹166.67**.
- ROAS = 72,000 / 15,000 = **4.8 (480%)**.

Example 6 (bounce rate). A website had 4,000 sessions, of which 1,200 viewed only one page and left. Bounce rate = 1,200 / 4,000 = **30%**.

Example 7 (on-page SEO for one page). Target keyword "AKTU previous year papers". Title tag: "AKTU Previous Year Papers 2025 (All Branches) | SiteName". Meta description of about 150 characters with the keyword. One H1 containing the keyword, H2s per branch, descriptive URL (/aktu-previous-year-papers), alt text on images, internal links to notes pages.

Key points to remember

- SEO: on-page, off-page, technical, local; crawl → index → rank; white-hat vs black-hat.
- SEM: PPC, Quality Score, Ad Rank, match types, campaign types.
- Formulas: CTR, CPC, CPM, conversion rate, CPA, ROAS, bounce rate.
- Mobile: SMS, WhatsApp, push, ASO, QR, geofencing. Video: hook, subtitles, vertical.
- Gamification: points, badges, leaderboards, scratch cards.

⭐ Important questions

1. What is SEO? Explain on-page, off-page and technical SEO with examples.
2. Explain search engine marketing and Google Ads. How do Quality Score and Ad Rank work? Compare SEO and SEM.
3. Explain content marketing and digital branding with examples.
4. Write notes on mobile marketing, video marketing and gamification.
5. Explain campaign analytics and key digital metrics. Calculate CTR, CPC, conversion rate and ROAS from given data.

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UNIT 4 Digital Transformation, Online PR and Measuring ROI

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Digital transformation:** the integration of digital technology into all areas of a business, changing how it operates and delivers value to customers.
- **Digitization:** converting analog information to digital form (scanning paper files).
- **Digitalization:** using digital data to improve existing processes (online forms instead of paper).
- **Digital leadership:** leading people and organizations through digital change, with a clear vision, data-driven decisions and a culture of experimentation.
- **Online public relations (online PR):** managing a brand's reputation and relationships through online media, influencers, press releases, social media and reviews.
- **Online reputation management (ORM):** monitoring and influencing what people say about a brand online (reviews, search results, social mentions).
- **Crisis communication:** quick, honest response to a negative event that threatens the brand's reputation online.
- **ROI (return on investment):** (gain from investment − cost of investment) / cost of investment × 100.
- **KPI (key performance indicator):** a measurable value that shows how well a goal is being achieved.
- **Customer lifetime value (CLV):** the total profit a business expects from a customer over the entire relationship.

💡 Core concepts

Digital transformation:

- **Drivers:** changing customer expectations, competition from digital-native firms, cheap cloud and mobile, data and AI, and government push (Digital India, UPI, ONDC).
- **Areas:** customer experience (apps, personalization), operations (automation, ERP, supply chain), business models (subscriptions, platforms, D2C), and culture and workforce skills.
- **Examples:** Asian Paints digitizing its supply chain; banks moving to mobile apps; Tata Neu super-app; kirana stores using UPI and ONDC.

Digital leadership:

- **Qualities:** vision, agility, customer-centricity, data literacy, collaboration across departments, willingness to experiment and learn from failure, and building digital skills in teams.
- **Roles:** CDO (Chief Digital Officer), CMO working with the CIO or CTO.
- **Challenges:** legacy systems, resistance to change, silos, skills gap, cybersecurity.

Online PR:

- **Tools:** online press releases and newsrooms, media relations with digital journalists, blogger and influencer outreach, social media engagement, podcasts and webinars, review management (Google, Amazon, Zomato), Wikipedia and knowledge panels, and thought leadership on LinkedIn.

- **ORM process:** monitor (social listening tools, Google Alerts) → assess sentiment → respond (thank positive, resolve negative publicly and then privately) → push positive content → measure.
- **Crisis steps:** acknowledge quickly, show empathy, give facts, take action, update regularly, learn.

Measuring ROI of digital marketing:

- **Steps:** set objectives and KPIs → track with analytics (UTM, conversion tracking, CRM) → attribute revenue to channels → calculate costs (ad spend, content, tools, people) → compute ROI and compare channels → reallocate budget.
- **KPIs by funnel stage:**
- Awareness: reach, impressions, CPM.
- Consideration: CTR, engagement, time on site.
- Conversion: conversion rate, CPA.
- Retention: repeat rate, churn, CLV.
- **Challenges:** multi-touch attribution, offline sales influenced online, brand value that is hard to measure, privacy limits on tracking.
- **ROAS vs ROI:** ROAS = revenue / ad spend (a channel efficiency ratio). ROI uses profit and all costs.

Examples and calculations

Example 8 (ROI with margin). Using Example 5 (revenue ₹72,000 from ₹15,000 ad spend) with a gross margin of 40%:

- Gross profit = 0.40 × 72,000 = ₹28,800.
- ROI = (28,800 − 15,000) / 15,000 × 100 = **92%**. (ROAS of 4.8 looks better than this because it ignores product cost.)

Example 9 (CLV and CAC). An average customer orders ₹800 four times a year for 3 years, and the margin is 25%. Customer acquisition cost (CAC) is ₹600.

- CLV = 800 × 4 × 3 × 0.25 = **₹2,400**.
- CLV : CAC = 2,400 : 600 = **4 : 1**. A ratio of about 3:1 or more is considered healthy, so this channel is worth scaling.

Example 10 (email KPIs). 10,000 emails sent, 9,800 delivered, 2,450 opened, 294 clicked.

- Delivery rate = 98%.
- Open rate = 2,450 / 9,800 = **25%**.
- Click-through rate = 294 / 9,800 = **3%**.
- Click-to-open rate = 294 / 2,450 = **12%**.

Key points to remember

- Digitization → digitalization → digital transformation.
- Digital leadership: vision, agility, data, culture; CDO role.
- Online PR and ORM: monitor, assess, respond, promote, measure; crisis steps.
- ROI = (gain − cost) / cost; ROAS = revenue / ad spend; CLV and CAC; KPIs by funnel stage.

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⭐ Important questions

1. What is digital transformation? Explain its drivers, areas and challenges with Indian examples.
2. Explain the role of digital leadership in transforming an organization.
3. What is online PR? Explain online reputation management and crisis communication.
4. How is the ROI of digital marketing measured? Explain KPIs at each funnel stage and attribution. Solve a numerical.
5. Distinguish ROI and ROAS. Explain CLV and its importance.

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UNIT 5 Transformation Framework, Security, Privacy and Trends

✍️ 2-mark definitions

- **Digital transformation framework:** a structured plan that guides an organization's digital change, covering strategy, customer, operations, technology, people and measurement.
- **Digital maturity:** how advanced an organization is in using digital technology and data across its business.
- **Data privacy:** the right of individuals to control how their personal data is collected, used and shared.
- **Personal data:** any data about an individual who can be identified by or in relation to that data.
- **DPDP Act 2023:** India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, which requires consent, purpose limitation and security for processing digital personal data, with penalties up to ₹250 crore per instance.
- **GDPR:** the European Union's General Data Protection Regulation (2018), a strict privacy law that also applies to non-EU firms serving EU residents.
- **Cookie:** a small file stored by a website in the browser to remember the user; third-party cookies track users across sites.
- **Phishing:** fraudulent messages that pretend to come from a trusted brand to steal data or money.
- **Online community:** a group of people who interact online around a shared interest, brand or purpose (forums, groups, Discord, Reddit).
- **Brand community:** an online community built around a brand, where customers help each other and share experiences (Royal Enfield riders' groups, Apple Support Communities).

💡 Core concepts

Digital transformation framework (stages):

1. **Assess** current state and digital maturity (customers, processes, technology, skills).
2. **Vision and strategy:** define where the business wants to be and why (customer value).
3. **Prioritize** use cases with clear business value (quick wins and long-term bets).
4. **Build the foundation:** cloud, data platform, CRM, cybersecurity, integration.
5. **People and culture:** leadership, skills, agile teams, change management.
6. **Execute** through pilots, then scale.
7. **Measure and iterate** with KPIs. - **Building blocks** (MIT and Capgemini model): customer experience, operational processes, business model, supported by digital capabilities and leadership.

Security in digital marketing:

- **Threats:** data breaches of customer databases, phishing and brand impersonation (fake pages and fake customer care numbers), account hijacking of social handles, ad fraud (bot clicks, fake impressions), malware in ads, fake reviews.
- **Safeguards:** HTTPS (SSL/TLS), strong passwords and two-factor authentication on ad and social accounts, role-based access, encryption of customer data, secure payment gateways (PCI DSS),

verified handles, monitoring for fake pages, ad fraud filters, staff training, and incident response plans.

Privacy:

- **Principles:** consent, purpose limitation, data minimization, accuracy, storage limitation, security, accountability, and user rights (access, correction, erasure).
- **DPDP Act 2023 key points:**
- Applies to digital personal data processed in India, and to processing outside India for offering goods or services in India.
- Requires clear notice and consent.
- Data Principal (individual) rights: access, correction, erasure, grievance redressal, nomination.
- Data Fiduciary (company) duties: security safeguards, breach notification.
- Children's data needs verifiable parental consent, and tracking and targeted ads at children are barred.
- The Data Protection Board of India enforces it; the DPDP Rules were notified in 2025.
- **Impact on marketing:** consent-based email and SMS lists (TRAI DND rules also apply), first-party data strategies, contextual targeting, privacy-friendly analytics.

Trends in India and globally:

- **India:** over 900 million internet users; mobile-first; low data costs; UPI; vernacular content; short video; social commerce (Meesho); quick commerce (Blinkit, Zepto); creator economy; ONDC; regional influencers.
- **Global:** AI-generated content and AI search answers, retail media networks (Amazon Ads), connected TV ads, AR try-ons, voice search, privacy-first measurement, sustainability messaging, and the creator economy.

Online communities:

- **Benefits:** loyalty, customer support (peer-to-peer), product feedback and co-creation, user-generated content, and advocacy.
- **Building one:** clear purpose, a platform (Facebook group, Discord, WhatsApp community, own forum), moderators and rules, regular activities (AMAs, challenges), rewarding active members, and listening.
- **Examples:** Royal Enfield owners' rides, Nykaa beauty community, Harley Owners Group (HOG), Zerodha's TradingQnA forum.

Examples and calculations

Example 11 (consent-friendly lead form). A coaching institute's form asks only name, phone and course interest (data minimization). It has an unticked checkbox: "I agree to receive course updates by WhatsApp and SMS." It links to a privacy notice explaining purpose, retention and how to withdraw consent. It also offers an opt-out link in every message.

Example 12 (community metric). A brand's WhatsApp community has 5,000 members; 600 posted or reacted this month. Monthly active participation = 600 / 5,000 = **12%**. If 20% of active members bought again, versus 5% of other customers, the community is worth investing in.

Key points to remember

- Framework: assess → vision → prioritize → foundation → people → execute → measure.
- Security threats: breaches, phishing, account hijack, ad fraud; safeguards: 2FA, HTTPS, encryption, access control.
- Privacy principles and DPDP Act 2023 (consent, rights, duties, children, penalties up to ₹250 crore, Data Protection Board).
- Trends: India (mobile, UPI, vernacular, quick commerce, ONDC) and global (AI, retail media, CTV, privacy-first).
- Online and brand communities: benefits, how to build, examples.

⭐ Important questions

1. Explain a digital transformation framework with its stages and building blocks.
2. Discuss security and privacy issues in digital marketing and how a firm can protect itself and its customers.
3. Explain the main provisions of India's DPDP Act 2023 and their effect on digital marketing.
4. Discuss the latest digital marketing trends in India and globally.
5. What are online communities? How can a brand build and use one? Give examples.

Last-hour checklist

☐ Traditional vs digital table; trends; consumer journey and funnel (AIDA, 5A, ZMOT); POEM; strategy (SMART, SOSTAC, RACE).

☐ Blogging benefits and post structure; content planning and calendar; 80/20 rule; platform comparison; Meta campaign structure; influencer tiers; engagement rate 3%.

☐ Content and branding; SEO on-page, off-page, technical, local; SEM, Quality Score, Ad Rank; mobile, video, gamification; metrics: CTR 1.5%, CPC ₹5, CPM ₹75, CR 3%, CPA ₹166.67, ROAS 4.8; bounce 30%.

☐ Digitization vs digitalization vs transformation; digital leadership; online PR, ORM, crisis steps; ROI 92%; CLV ₹2,400 and 4:1; email open 25%, CTR 3%, CTOR 12%.

☐ Transformation framework; security threats and safeguards; privacy principles; DPDP Act 2023; trends; online communities.

Books prescribed by AKTU

These are the books named in the official AKTU syllabus. Buy or borrow them through a bookshop or your college library. The WorldCat links show which libraries hold a copy.

#	Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Where to get it legally
1	Internet Marketing: A Practical Approach in the Indian Context	Moutusy Maity	Oxford University Press India	WorldCat

#	Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Where to get it legally
2	Digital Marketing	Vandana Ahuja	Oxford University Press (2015)	WorldCat
3	Strategic Digital Marketing	Eric Greenberg, Alexander Kates	McGraw-Hill	WorldCat
4	Understanding Digital Marketing	Damian Ryan	Kogan Page	WorldCat
5	Social Media Marketing	Tracy L. Tuten, Michael R. Solomon	Sage	WorldCat

Syllabus source: AKTU Open Elective-III and IV syllabus for B.Tech 8th semester, 2025-26 (copy hosted by an affiliated college, PDF)

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